

Alexander Oswald

Senior Game Data Analyst | Player Behavioural Analysis · Telemetry · Experimentation · Data Modelling · Systems Design

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Game Data Analyst with 10+ years in live-service games. Deep expertise in player behavioural analysis, telemetry event data, experimentation, and data modelling. At my best in smaller studios where analytics had to be built and constantly justified — not inherited. The most durable wins came from diagnosing structural problems others were looking past: retention failures hiding in the numbers, economy imbalances that quietly drove players away, social dynamics that determined whether a player stayed or left for good. Drawn to games that earn loyalty rather than manufacture urgency — the ones players remember, return to, and recommend without being asked. Sky is exactly that kind of game.

SKILLS & DOMAIN KNOWLEDGE

Programming SQL (Expert), Python, R, HiveQL, Bash

BI & Delivery Tableau, Looker (Enterprise LookML), Hex w/Jupyter Notebooks, Amplitude, QuickSight, RMarkdown, RShiny

Data Storage & Warehousing Snowflake, PostgreSQL, Redshift, Athena, S3, Glue, Parquet & Iceberg; GCP: BigQuery, Cloud Storage; NoSQL (Cassandra, MongoDB)

Cloud Platforms AWS (S3, Athena, Glue, Lambda, Firehose, EC2); GCP (BigQuery, Cloud Storage, Dataflow patterns)

Data Tools & Platforms dbt, Airflow/Prefect, MLflow, Jenkins, Git/GitHub

Game Telemetry & Event Analytics Behavioural event log analysis, economy event streams (delta/balance events), NoSQL record extraction, PySpark distributed processing, anomaly detection on irregular-cadence events, data quality monitoring

A/B Testing & Experimentation A/B test design, quasi-experimental methods, propensity score matching, diff-in-diff, guardrail metrics, SRM checks, network/spillover effects, uplift measurement

Game Systems & Player Analytics Matchmaking quality, player progression, gameplay balance, economy shocks, content cadence, behavioural segmentation, retention/churn drivers, social network effects, long-term player health

ML Modelling Churn prediction, LTV forecasting, clustering, recommendation systems, multi-armed bandits, conversion modelling, anomaly detection

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Savepoint Analytics — Game Analytics Consulting

Founder & Principal Analyst

Victoria, BC (Remote) · Mar 2026 – Present

Independent consultancy serving indie and scaling studios without internal analytics capacity.

- Advising studios on telemetry event schema design — balancing analytical coverage with game-agnostic structures built for long-term reusability.
- Designing analytics platform architectures using AWS, dbt, and modern BI tooling sized for lean game teams.

Kano Apps — Casual Games

Senior Game Data Engineer & BI Analyst

Victoria, BC Canada · May 2025 – Feb 2026

Hired to rebuild Kano's analytics data model from the ground up — redesigning transformation architecture on dbt/Athena/Parquet/Iceberg, enforcing data quality across migrated pipelines, and restoring stakeholder trust degraded by years of undocumented technical debt.

- Rebuilt the player data transformation layer — migrating R ETLs into incremental dbt-Athena models on partitioned Parquet/Iceberg tables, cutting daily report refresh from up to 14 hours to under 1 hour and reducing EC2/Athena costs by 23%.
- Rebuilt and extended the event anomaly detection system in Python — expanding coverage to irregular-cadence live-ops events, improving behavioural signal monitoring that flags unexpected shifts in player activity including patterns indicative of data integrity issues.
- Migrated RShiny dashboards to QuickSight and replaced fragile cron scripts with Prefect workflows, improving orchestration reliability and long-term maintainability.
- Executed R-to-Python migration of a 10,000+ line undocumented codebase using bilingual expertise and selective LLM-assisted translation, preserving full analytical parity throughout.

Kixeye Inc / Stillfront Group — Mobile Games

Lead Data Analyst, Core Analytics Team Lead

Victoria, BC Canada · Feb 2022 – Jan 2025

Led Kixeye's Core Analytics Team while owning data modelling and KPI standardisation across multiple studios — where cross-studio accuracy and cost efficiency were both hard constraints. Most durable wins came from diagnosing structural retention problems others framed as spend issues.

- Diagnosed a PvP retention failure others were treating as a spend problem — built multi-objective logistic models (match-initiation propensity, economy sink, 7-day engagement), simulated optimal defender configurations, and drove a retention lift of up to 2pp from D14 onward in mid-progression players, with incremental late-cohort revenue among returning spenders.
- Built a long-term revenue forecasting model in R and Python for an M&A; acquisition assessment — identifying and correcting a \$14M overestimation before deal close.
- Designed and enforced a unified KPI data model across Kixeye and Stillfront sister studios — standardising definitions and ensuring cross-title consistency under significant Snowflake cost scrutiny; reduced warehousing costs 45% (~\$130K/year).
- Independently migrated Kixeye and Babil Games dashboards onto Stillfront's shared Looker instance, saving \$90K annually while preserving uninterrupted reporting continuity.
- Supported GCP-to-AWS analytics pipeline migration — contributing data modelling expertise as streaming/batch flows were rebuilt on Firehose/Lambda/Kinesis; developed working familiarity with GCP (BigQuery, Cloud Storage) in the process.

Senior Product Analyst, Acting Core Analytics Team Lead

Victoria, BC Canada · Jan 2021 – Feb 2022

- Built an Alliance Recommendation Engine in Python — ranking social groups by predicted engagement uplift — materially improving player retention and contributing to a 7% annual revenue increase.
- Discovered elevated churn among high-value players caused by weak alliance network effects; used logit regression to quantify PvP disengagement and partnered with Engineering on interim guardrails while a longer-term matchmaking redesign was scoped.
- Helped Design remediate multiple churn triggers in progression, balance, and economy using Bayesian logistic regressions when A/B tests were infeasible; automated A/B reporting and KPI forecasting ETLs.

Product Analyst, War Commander: Rogue Assault

Vancouver, BC Canada · Aug 2019 – Jan 2021

- Analysed large-scale player economy event streams (Lambda delta/balance events) using PySpark — early hands-on telemetry work at volume requiring careful event sequencing and state reconstruction.
- Repaired legacy SQL ETL pipelines in the first three months, restoring core reporting trust; proposed a revised UA strategy that cut time to campaign profitability from 200 days to 90.
- Migrated ML pipelines and revenue attribution SQL from Domino to Jenkins using PySpark batch scoring, cutting monthly platform costs by \$27K.

Electronic Arts — AAA Games

Data Scientist, Dynamic Experiences Team

Burnaby, BC Canada · Nov 2018 – Jul 2019

- Designed and evaluated A/B test live-ops messaging campaigns for FIFA using R, SQL, and HiveQL — generated \$2M in incremental FIFA 19 revenue and a 3% spend increase in targeted player segments. Built MAB recommendation engines in Ruby for FIFA 20 and churn/reacquisition models in R.

Business Analyst, FIFA Player Analytics Team

Burnaby, BC Canada · Jun 2016 – Nov 2018

- Applied propensity score matching in R to measure the causal spend lift from FIFA's Companion and Web Apps — the evidence base that saved the Web App from discontinuation (4.2%/7.0% incremental spend lift). Presented at EA's 2018 Analyticon; influenced Madden team to build a companion app.
- Extracted and analysed large-scale FIFA trade records from NoSQL using RSpark (Scala) — first hands-on exposure to raw event-level player data at AAA scale.
- Delivered monthly behavioural analysis and executive reporting for EA Sports, earning expanded scope across Motive, BioWare, and DICE studios.

Pretio Interactive — Ad Tech · Data Scientist · Victoria, BC · Jul 2015 – Feb 2016

- Built probabilistic ad conversion models and extracted MAB exploration data from an EpsilonGreedy algorithm; automated performance reporting for the sales team in a live environment.

TinyMob Games — Indie Game Startup · Data Analyst · Victoria, BC · Nov 2014 – Jul 2015

- Identified a player segment with elevated early churn, attributed it to a gameplay balance issue, and collaborated with design on fixes — improving D7 retention from 11.3% to 14.2%.
- Diagnosed the root cause of Tiny Realms' F2P economy failure: a structural free-rider dynamic where players benefited from others' spending without converting themselves.

EDUCATION

M.A. Economics — Auctions & Experimental Economics University of Victoria · 2011–2014 · Phillips, Hager & North Master's Scholarship · Published thesis on timber lot auction optimisation (cirano.qc.ca/files/publications/2015RP-05.pdf)

B.Sc. Economics — Minor in Mathematics Illinois State University · 2006–2010